

Medication Refusals – Quick Reference

■ **Process**

- Respect patient/service user right to refuse medication
- Attempt to understand reason for refusal calmly
- Provide explanation of benefits and risks (no coercion)
- Offer alternative (time, form, or method if appropriate)
- Do not conceal medication unless authorised (covert policy)

■ **Documentation**

- Record refusal immediately on MAR/chart
- Document reason for refusal (if given)
- Record actions taken (education, re-offer)
- Include date, time, and staff signature
- Update care plan if repeated refusals occur

■ **Escalation**

- Inform nurse/manager if medication is critical
- Escalate repeated refusals to GP/pharmacist
- Report if refusal impacts health or safety
- Consider capacity assessment if concerns present
- Follow safeguarding procedures if risk identified

Stay compliant • Ensure safety • Follow clinical and regulatory guidance